

credit card he applied for. He had to cancel his trip abroad because he had trouble getting a visa. A few years later, Tony moved to New York and started applying to graduate schools. Every application he filled out, he had to check the “yes” box next to “Do you have a misdemeanor on your permanent record?” When Tony didn’t get into a program, he tried to enter the workforce. But every job application asked the same question. That little box seriously hurt Tony’s chances of getting hired by a respectable company. He finally found an organization that was willing to overlook his past indiscretions, but he knows his salary has suffered because of it.

A criminal record is virtually impossible to expunge, and it’s going to hit you right where it hurts: in the wallet. I don’t care if you’re having the time of your life right now; you’ve got to think about your future. One careless night of “fun” is all it takes to make a big mistake—one you could spend the rest of your life paying for.

Money Mistake: *You’re Only Going to University to Placate Your Parents*

The Fix: *Consider a Cold Hard Cash Career*

If you’ve read my second book, you know I’m not one of those people who think everyone should go to university. It may not be the best choice for you—and that’s perfectly okay. Better to figure that out now before your parents bankrupt themselves trying to pay for a career you can’t stand.

Once upon a time, every proud mama and papa wanted their precious little cherub to grow up to be a rich doctor, lawyer or banker. Today’s landscape has changed. These days it can pay to be a blue-collar worker. And I mean that literally. In the “Best Jobs in Canada” rankings for 2013, seven construction and resource-sector jobs made it into the top 50. Not just that, but “oil and gas drilling supervisor” nabbed the number one spot. The “best jobs” are ranked using Canadian data on employment and wages over a six-year span, meaning these positions are some of the best in the country in terms of salary, growth potential, job availability and future